

Olympiad Test Paper — Sanskrit (Class 7) — Paper 3

Chapter 14: शब्दरूपाणि (Shabda-Rupani: Noun Declensions)

Paper 3 — (progressively harder)

Subject	Sanskrit (NCERT Class 7, Deepakam)
Chapter	14 — शब्दरूपाणि (Shabda-Rupani: Noun Declensions)
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. Paper-3 traps: every form must be self-verified. Reverse the easy questions — given a FORM, name its vibhakti AND vacana (देवेषु = सप्तमी बहुवचन, not षष्ठी); supply the RIGHT form for a new context sentence; and tell apart look-alikes across stems (देवात् abl. vs कवेः abl./gen.; गुरवे dat. vs गुरवः nom.pl.; कविना inst. vs कवीन् acc.pl.). Remember the syncretisms (dat.pl. = abl.pl. -एभ्यः/-भ्यः; inst./dat./abl. dual share -आभ्याम्/-भ्याम्; gen./loc. dual share -योः) and the इ/उ ablative=genitive singular (कवेः, गुरोः). Stay within the three masculine stems taught: देव (अकारान्त), कवि (इकारान्त), गुरु (उकारान्त). Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

1. Across all three numbers, the तृतीया (instrumental), चतुर्थी (dative) and पञ्चमी (ablative) of देव share ONE identical form. In which number does that happen, and what is the form?

- (A) the plural — देवेभ्यः (B) the dual — देवाभ्याम्
(C) the singular — देवेन (D) the plural — देवैः

2. In the अकारान्त plural, which TWO cases share the identical ending -एभ्यः (e.g. देवेभ्यः)?

- (A) instrumental (तृतीया) and dative (चतुर्थी) (B) genitive (षष्ठी) and locative (सप्तमी)
(C) nominative (प्रथमा) and accusative (द्वितीया) (D) dative (चतुर्थी) and ablative (पञ्चमी)

3. Counting the seven cases plus the vocative across all three numbers, how many cells does one complete masculine declension table contain (ignoring forms that happen to coincide)?

- (A) 21 (B) 18
(C) 24 (D) 8

4. In which TWO cases do देव, कवि and गुरु all show the SAME dual form built on -यो: (i.e. देवयोः, कव्योः, गुरोः)?

- (A) instrumental (तृतीया) and dative (चतुर्थी) (B) genitive (षष्ठी) and locative (सप्तमी)
(C) nominative (प्रथमा) and accusative (द्वितीया) (D) dative (चतुर्थी) and ablative (पञ्चमी)

5. A student says 'the dual ending is always -औ'. Testing this on the three taught stems, which statement is correct?

- (A) all three take -औ: देवौ, कविौ, गुरौ (B) all three take -ई: देवी, कवी, गुरी
(C) the dual ending is always -आभ्याम् in every case
(D) the nominative dual is देवौ but कवी and गुरु — the dual marker is -औ only on अकारान्त stems

6. Why does knowing the देव paradigm by itself NOT let you decline कवि or गुरु correctly?

- (A) they are feminine, so they take feminine endings
(B) they are verbs, not nouns
(C) कवि and गुरु belong to different stem-classes (इकारान्त, उकारान्त) with their own endings — e.g. instrumental singular कविना/गुरुणा, not -एन
(D) they have only two numbers instead of three

7. Identify the vibhakti AND vacana of देवेषु.

- (A) locative (सप्तमी) plural — 'in/among the gods'
(B) genitive (षष्ठी) plural — 'of the gods' (C) locative (सप्तमी) singular — 'in the god'
(D) dative (चतुर्थी) plural — 'to the gods'

8. देवान् is which form?

- (A) accusative (द्वितीया) plural — the gods as object
(B) nominative (प्रथमा) plural — the gods as subject
(C) ablative (पञ्चमी) singular — from the god (D) genitive (षष्ठी) plural — of the gods

9. Which single form serves as BOTH the dative singular and... no — pick the form that is the अकारान्त ablative singular of देव.

- (A) देवाय (B) देवात्
(C) देवानाम् (D) देवेभ्यः

10. In the sentence 'देवस्य पुत्रः क्रीडति' the bold word देवस्य answers which question about पुत्रः?

- (A) to whom? — it is the dative (चतुर्थी) (B) by whom? — it is the instrumental (तृतीया)
(C) from whom? — it is the ablative (पञ्चमी)
(D) whose? — it is the genitive (षष्ठी), 'of the god / the god's'

11. Supply the missing अकारान्त form: nominative देवः, accusative देवम्, instrumental _____, dative देवाय.

- (A) देवस्य (B) देवेन
(C) देवात् (D) देवे

12. The form देवैः is the अकारान्त plural of which case, and what does it mean?

- (A) instrumental (तृतीया) plural — 'by/with the gods'
- (B) dative (चतुर्थी) plural — 'to the gods' (C) genitive (षष्ठी) plural — 'of the gods'
- (D) locative (सप्तमी) plural — 'among the gods'

13. Which pair correctly gives the देव DUAL for the nominative and the genitive respectively?

- (A) देवौ and देवानाम्
- (B) देवौ and देवयोः
- (C) देवाः and देवयोः
- (D) देवौ and देवाभ्याम्

14. A learner writes 'देवे' and 'देवयोः' for the locative. Which numbers do these two forms mark?

- (A) देवे = locative plural; देवयोः = locative singular
- (B) देवे = locative dual; देवयोः = locative plural
- (C) देवे = locative singular; देवयोः = locative dual
- (D) both are the locative singular

15. Give the nominative SINGULAR, DUAL and PLURAL of कवि ('poet') in order.

- (A) कविः, कवी, कवयः
- (B) कविः, कविौ, कवीन्
- (C) कविः, कवी, कवीन्
- (D) कविः, कवयः, कवीनाम्

16. Identify the vibhakti and vacana of कवीन्.

- (A) nominative (प्रथमा) plural — 'the poets' as subject
- (B) genitive (षष्ठी) plural — 'of the poets' (C) instrumental (तृतीया) plural — 'by the poets'
- (D) accusative (द्वितीया) plural — 'the poets' as object

17. For कवि, the ablative singular and the genitive singular are the SAME form. What is it?

- (A) कवेः
- (B) कवये
- (C) कविना
- (D) कवौ

18. The dative singular of कवि is —

- (A) कवेः
- (B) कविना
- (C) कविभ्यः
- (D) कवये

19. Which is the instrumental SINGULAR of कवि, and why is it not कविना's plural-looking cousin?

- (A) कविभिः — 'by the poet' (B) कवये — 'by the poet'
- (C) कविम् — 'by the poet'
- (D) कविना — 'by the poet'; the instrumental plural is the distinct कविभिः

20. What is the genitive PLURAL of कवि?

- (A) कवेः
- (B) कवीनाम्
- (C) कविभ्यः
- (D) कविषु

21. The locative singular of कवि is कवौ. Which of these is its locative PLURAL?

(A) कवौ

(B) कव्योः

(C) कविषु

(D) कवीनाम्

22. हरि (Vishnu) and मुनि (sage) decline exactly like which paradigm, and what is their nominative plural?

(A) like देव (अकारान्त); nominative plural हराः, मुनाः

(B) like गुरु (उकारान्त); nominative plural हरवः, मुनवः

(C) like देव (अकारान्त); nominative plural हरयः, मुनयः

(D) like कवि (इकारान्त); nominative plural हरयः, मुनयः

23. Give the nominative SINGULAR, DUAL and PLURAL of गुरु ('teacher') in order.

(A) गुरुः, गुरु, गुरवः

(B) गुरुः, गुरु, गुरुन्

(C) गुरुः, गुरौ, गुरवः

(D) गुरुः, गुरवः, गुरुणाम्

24. The form गुरवे is which case of गुरु, and how does it differ from गुरवः?

(A) dative singular ('to/for the teacher'); गुरवः is the nominative plural ('the teachers')

(B) nominative plural; गुरवः is the dative singular

(C) instrumental singular; गुरवः is the genitive singular

(D) vocative singular; गुरवः is the accusative plural

25. For गुरु, the ablative singular and the genitive singular share ONE form. What is it?

(A) गुरवे

(B) गुरोः

(C) गुरुणा

(D) गुरौ

26. Identify the vibhakti and vacana of गुरुन्.

(A) accusative (द्वितीया) plural — 'the teachers' as object

(B) nominative (प्रथमा) plural — 'the teachers' as subject

(C) ablative (पञ्चमी) singular — 'from the teacher'

(D) genitive (षष्ठी) plural — 'of the teachers'

27. What is the instrumental SINGULAR of गुरु?

(A) गुरुभिः

(B) गुरवे

(C) गुरुणा

(D) गुरुणाम्

28. The genitive plural of गुरु is —

(A) गुरुणाम्

(B) गुरोः

(C) गुरुभ्यः

(D) गुरुणा

29. The locative singular of गुरु is गुरौ. What is its locative PLURAL?

(A) गुरुषु

(B) गुरौ

(C) गुर्वोः

(D) गुरुणाम्

30. Which two forms are correctly matched? (देव paradigm) देवात् and (कवि paradigm) कवेः both mark which case in the singular?

- (A) both can be the ablative ('from'): देवात् is purely ablative, कवेः is ablative=genitive
(B) both are purely the genitive ('of') (C) both are purely the dative ('to/for')
(D) both are the instrumental ('by')

31. A student confuses कविना and कवीन्. Which statement correctly tells them apart?

- (A) कविना is accusative plural; कवीन् is instrumental singular
(B) both are the nominative plural
(C) कविना is dative singular; कवीन् is genitive plural
(D) कविना is instrumental singular ('by the poet'); कवीन् is accusative plural ('the poets', object)

32. देवेन, कविना and गुरुणा are the same case in the same number across three stems. Which case and number?

- (A) dative (चतुर्थी) singular — 'to/for the ____'
(B) ablative (पञ्चमी) singular — 'from the ____' (C) genitive (षष्ठी) singular — 'of the ____'
(D) instrumental (तृतीया) singular — 'by/with the ____'

33. Which group lists ONLY genitive-plural forms (the '-of the many' form) across the three stems?

- (A) देवेभ्यः, कविभ्यः, गुरुभ्यः (B) देवेषु, कविषु, गुरुषु
(C) देवैः, कविभिः, गुरुभिः (D) देवानाम्, कवीनाम्, गुरुणाम्

34. Which group lists ONLY locative-plural forms ('in/among the many')?

- (A) देवानाम्, कवीनाम्, गुरुणाम् (B) देवेभ्यः, कविभ्यः, गुरुभ्यः
(C) देवेषु, कविषु, गुरुषु (D) देवे, कवौ, गुरौ

35. Which group lists ONLY dative/ablative PLURAL forms ('to/from the many')?

- (A) देवैः, कविभिः, गुरुभिः (B) देवेभ्यः, कविभ्यः, गुरुभ्यः
(C) देवानाम्, कवीनाम्, गुरुणाम् (D) देवाय, कवये, गुरवे

36. A learner pairs गुरवे with कवयः as 'the same form in two stems'. Why is the pairing wrong?

- (A) they are the same case but गुरवे is dual and कवयः is singular
(B) both are datives, so the pairing is actually correct
(C) गुरवे is dative singular of गुरु, but कवयः is nominative plural of कवि — different case AND number
(D) both are nominative plural, so the pairing is actually correct

37. Which of these is the correct accusative SINGULAR for its stem?

- (A) गुरुन् (accusative singular of गुरु) (B) कवयः (accusative singular of कवि)
(C) गुरुम् (accusative singular of गुरु) (D) देवान् (accusative singular of देव)

38. देवस्य : देव :: कवेः : ? — complete the analogy for the genitive singular.

- (A) गुरु (कवेः is the genitive singular of गुरु)(B) कवि (कवेः is the genitive singular of कवि)
(C) देव (कवेः is the genitive singular of देव)(D) हरि — but the form should be हरिस्य

39. Supply the right form: 'बालकः _____ नमति' meaning 'the boy bows TO the teacher' (गुरु).

- (A) गुरोः (genitive/ablative — 'of/from the teacher')
(B) गुरुणा (instrumental — 'by the teacher')(C) गुरवे (dative — 'to/for the teacher')
(D) गुरौ (locative — 'in the teacher')

40. Supply the right form: 'सः _____ काव्यं शृणोति' meaning 'he hears a poem FROM the poet' (कवि).

- (A) कवये (dative — 'to the poet') (B) कवेः (ablative — 'from the poet')
(C) कविना (instrumental — 'by the poet') (D) कविम् (accusative — 'the poet')

41. Supply the right form: 'सः _____ सह वसति' meaning 'he lives WITH the teacher' (गुरु) — सह governs the instrumental.

- (A) गुरवे (dative) (B) गुरोः (genitive/ablative)
(C) गुरुणा (instrumental — 'with the teacher')(D) गुरौ (locative)

42. Supply the right form: 'मम विश्वासः _____ अस्ति' meaning 'my faith is IN the god' (देव).

- (A) देवे (locative — 'in the god') (B) देवस्य (genitive — 'of the god')
(C) देवाय (dative — 'to the god') (D) देवेन (instrumental — 'by the god')

43. Supply the right form for 'two': 'अत्र _____ तिष्ठतः' meaning 'here stand TWO teachers' (गुरु).

- (A) गुरवः (nominative plural — 'teachers')(B) गुरुः (nominative singular — 'a teacher')
(C) गुरुन् (accusative plural) (D) गुरु (nominative dual — 'two teachers')

44. Supply the right form: 'रामः _____ पश्यति' meaning 'Rama sees the poets' (more than two) (कवि).

- (A) कवयः (nominative plural — 'the poets', subject)
(B) कवी (accusative dual — 'two poets') (C) कविम् (accusative singular — 'the poet')
(D) कवीन् (accusative plural — 'the poets', object)

45. Supply the right form: 'अहं _____ नमामि' meaning 'I bow to the gods' (more than two) (देव).

- (A) देवान् (accusative plural — 'the gods') (B) देवाय (dative singular — 'to the god')
(C) देवेभ्यः (dative plural — 'to the gods') (D) देवानाम् (genitive plural — 'of the gods')

46. Supply the right form: 'सः _____ शिष्यः अस्ति' meaning 'he is the teacher's pupil' (गुरु).

- (A) गुरवे (dative — 'to the teacher') (B) गुरुणा (instrumental — 'by the teacher')
(C) गुरोः (genitive — 'of the teacher / the teacher's')
(D) गुरौ (locative — 'in the teacher')

47. Supply the right form: 'काव्यं _____ रचितम्' meaning 'the poem was composed BY the poet' (कवि).

(A) कवये (dative — 'to the poet')

(B) कवे: (genitive/ablative — 'of/from the poet')

(C) कवौ (locative — 'in the poet')

(D) कविना (instrumental — 'by the poet')

48. Supply the right form: 'पुष्पाणि _____ सन्ति' meaning 'flowers are on the trees' (तरु, a उकारान्त noun like गुरु; more than two).

(A) तरुणाम् (genitive plural — 'of the trees') (B) तरुषु (locative plural — 'on the trees')

(C) तरुभ्यः (dative/ablative plural — 'to/from the trees')

(D) तरौ (locative singular — 'on the tree')

49. The vocative singular forms हे देव!, हे कवे! and हे गुरो! show three different changes. Which description is exactly right?

(A) all three simply drop the final -ः

(B) अकारान्त drops -ः (हे देव!); इकारान्त shifts -इ: to -ए (हे कवे!); उकारान्त shifts -उ: to -ओ (हे गुरो!)

(C) all three add -ओ to the stem

(D) all three change the final vowel to -ए

50. What is the vocative DUAL of गुरु ('O you two teachers!')

(A) हे गुरो!

(B) हे गुरुवः!

(C) हे गुरुवे!

(D) हे गुरु!

51. What is the vocative PLURAL of कवि ('O poets!')

(A) हे कवयः!

(B) हे कवे!

(C) हे कवी!

(D) हे कवीन्!

52. A student writes 'हे गुरु:!' to address one teacher. What is the correct form and the rule?

(A) हे गुरु: is correct — the vocative equals the nominative

(B) हे गुरो! — the उकारान्त vocative singular changes -उ: to -ओ

(C) हे गुरुवे! — the vocative equals the dative

(D) हे गुरुम्! — the vocative equals the accusative

53. Across देव, कवि and गुरु, which statement about the vocative singular versus the nominative singular is TRUE?

(A) all three vocatives are identical to their nominatives

(B) all three vocatives differ from their nominatives: देव:→हे देव!, कवि:→हे कवे!, गुरु:→हे गुरो!

(C) only देव's vocative differs; कवि and गुरु keep the nominative

(D) the vocative and nominative differ only in the plural

54. हे साधो! addresses a साधु ('good man'). What does this tell us about साधु's stem-class?

(A) it is अकारान्त (like देव): the vocative drops -ः

(B) it is इकारान्त (like कवि): the vocative इ→ए

(C) it has no fixed class; vocatives are irregular

(D) it is उकारान्त (like गुरु): the vocative उ→ओ gives हे साधो!

55. देवौ means 'two gods'. To rewrite a sentence so it means 'all the gods (many)' as the SUBJECT, which form replaces देवौ?

(A) देवान् (accusative plural)

(B) देवानाम् (genitive plural)

(C) देवाः (nominative plural)

(D) देवेषु (locative plural)

56. A child writes 'मम नेत्रे' for 'my two eyes' using a dual, but then writes 'गुरुः' meaning 'my two teachers'. What is the error?

(A) for exactly two teachers the dual गुरु is needed; गुरुः is the plural (three or more)

(B) गुरुः is correct; the dual and plural are interchangeable

(C) the dual is wrong for eyes too; नेत्रे should be plural

(D) गुरुः should be गुरुः, the singular

57. In 'गुरुः शिष्याय ज्ञानं ददाति' ('the teacher gives knowledge to the pupil'), identify the cases of गुरुः, शिष्याय and ज्ञानम्.

(A) गुरुः = nominative; शिष्याय = genitive ('of the pupil'); ज्ञानम् = nominative

(B) गुरुः = nominative (subject); शिष्याय = dative (recipient 'to'); ज्ञानम् = accusative (object given)

(C) गुरुः = vocative; शिष्याय = dative; ज्ञानम् = instrumental

(D) गुरुः = accusative; शिष्याय = ablative; ज्ञानम् = dative

58. Which sentence uses देवस्य CORRECTLY for its meaning?

(A) 'अहं देवस्य नमामि' = 'I bow to the god' (it should be the dative देवाय)

(B) 'सः देवस्य आगच्छति' = 'he comes from the god' (it should be the ablative देवात्)

(C) 'देवस्य मन्दिरम् अस्ति' = 'it is the god's temple' (genitive, possession)

(D) 'पुष्पं देवस्य अस्ति' meaning 'a flower is on the god' (it should be the locative देवे)

59. A student claims: 'गुरोः and कवेः are the same case because they look alike, and both are only ablatives.' What is the accurate correction?

(A) they are identical forms of one stem (B) both are purely genitive, never ablative

(C) each is the ablative=genitive singular of its OWN stem: गुरोः belongs to गुरु (उकारान्त), कवेः to कवि (इकारान्त); both cover ablative AND genitive

(D) गुरोः is a dative and कवेः is an instrumental

60. Final synthesis — which set of four forms is ALL correctly labelled?

(A) देवैः = instrumental pl.; कवीनाम् = genitive pl.; गुरुवे = dative sg.; देवात् = ablative sg.

(B) देवैः = dative pl.; कवीनाम् = locative pl.; गुरुवे = nominative pl.; देवात् = accusative sg.

(C) देवैः = instrumental pl.; कवीनाम् = genitive pl.; गुरुवे = genitive sg.; देवात् = genitive sg.

(D) देवैः = genitive pl.; कवीनाम् = instrumental pl.; गुरुवे = dative sg.; देवात् = ablative sg.

Solutions — Sanskrit (Class 7), Chapter 14: शब्दरूपाणि (Shabda-Rupani: Noun Declensions) — Paper 3

Paper 3 — (progressively harder)

Marking: +4 correct, -1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	B	11	B	21	C	31	D	41	C	51	A
2	D	12	A	22	D	32	D	42	A	52	B
3	C	13	B	23	A	33	D	43	D	53	B
4	B	14	C	24	A	34	C	44	D	54	D
5	D	15	A	25	B	35	B	45	C	55	C
6	C	16	D	26	A	36	C	46	C	56	A
7	A	17	A	27	C	37	C	47	D	57	B
8	A	18	D	28	A	38	B	48	B	58	C
9	B	19	D	29	A	39	C	49	B	59	C
10	D	20	B	30	A	40	B	50	D	60	A

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

1. (B) In the अकारान्त dual, instrumental, dative and ablative all collapse to a single -आभ्याम् form: देवाभ्याम्. This three-case syncretism in the dual is a hallmark of every Sanskrit noun. In the plural only dative and ablative merge (both -एभ्यः, देवेभ्यः) while the instrumental stays distinct (देवैः); in the singular all three differ (देवेन / देवाय / देवात्).

2. (D) The dative plural and ablative plural both end in -एभ्यः, so देवेभ्यः serves for 'to/for the gods' and 'from the gods' alike. The instrumental plural is the distinct देवैः; genitive plural is देवानाम् and locative plural देवेषु; nominative/accusative plurals are देवाः / देवान्.

3. (C) Eight forms (seven cases + the vocative) times three numbers (singular, dual, plural) gives $8 \times 3 = 24$ cells. 21 would be seven cases $\times$ three numbers, omitting the vocative; 18 omits both the vocative and assumes only some numbers; 8 is the count of forms in a single number alone.

4. (B) The genitive dual and locative dual always merge into one -यो: form: देवयोः, कव्योः, गुरोः each cover both 'of the two' and 'in the two'. The instrumental/dative/ablative dual share the other dual form (-आभ्याम्/-भ्याम्), while nominative and accusative dual share the -औ/-ई/-ऊ form.

5. (D) The nominative/accusative dual is देवौ (अ + औ), but for इ-stems it is कवी (इ lengthens to ई) and for उ-stems गुरु (उ lengthens to ऊ). So -औ is not universal; it is specific to अकारान्त. -आभ्याम्/-भ्याम् is the instrumental/dative/ablative dual, not every case.

6. (C) देव is अकारान्त; its endings (देवेन, देवाय, देवात्...) belong to that class only. कवि is इकारान्त (instrumental कविना, dative कविने) and गुरु is उकारान्त (instrumental गुरुणा, dative गुरवे). The classes share the CASE-NAMES and their roles, but each has its own endings — they are masculine nouns, not feminine, not verbs, and all three keep all three numbers.

7. (A) देवेषु ends in -एषु, the अकारान्त locative plural: 'in/among the gods'. The genitive plural is देवानाम्; the locative singular is देवे; the dative plural is देवेभ्यः. A common slip is confusing the locative plural -एषु with the genitive plural -आनाम्.

8. (A) देवान् (-आन्) is the अकारान्त accusative plural: 'the gods' as the thing acted upon. The nominative plural is देवाः; the ablative singular is देवात् (note the dental -त्, not -न); the genitive plural is देवानाम्. Confusing देवान् (acc.pl.) with देवात् (abl.sg.) is the classic trap here.

9. (B) The ablative singular of देव is देवात् ('from the god'). देवाय is the dative singular ('to/for'); देवानाम् is the genitive plural ('of the gods'); देवेभ्यः is the dative/ablative plural ('to/from the gods'). The singular ablative and dative are distinct (देवात् vs देवाय); they only merge in the plural and dual.

10. (D) देवस्य is the genitive singular (-स्य), marking possession: 'the god's son plays'. 'To whom' would be the dative देवाय; 'by whom' the instrumental देवेन; 'from whom' the ablative देवात्. The genitive is the case that answers 'whose?'.

11. (B) The instrumental singular of देव is देवेन ('by/with the god'). देवस्य is the genitive, देवात् the ablative, देवे the locative. The paradigm runs देवः—देवम्—देवेन—देवाय—देवात्—देवस्य—देवे in the singular.

12. (A) देवैः (-ऐः) is the instrumental plural: 'by/with the gods'. The dative/ablative plural is देवेभ्यः, the genitive plural देवानाम्, the locative plural देवेषु. देवैः is the one plural form that the dative does NOT share.

13. (B) The nominative dual is देवौ ('two gods') and the genitive dual is देवयोः ('of the two gods'). देवानाम् is the genitive plural; देवाः is the nominative plural; देवाभ्याम् is the instrumental/dative/ablative dual, not the genitive dual.

14. (C) देवे (-ए) is the locative singular ('in the god') and देवयोः (-योः) is the locative dual ('in the two gods'), shared with the genitive dual. The locative plural is the distinct देवेषु. So one

stem gives देवे / देवयोः / देवेषु across the three numbers.

15. (A) For इकारान्त कवि the nominative is कविः (sg.), कवी (dual, इ→ई), कवयः (pl., -अयः). कवीन् is the accusative plural (object), not nominative; कविौ is not a valid इ-stem dual (the dual is कवी); कवीनाम् is the genitive plural. The nominative trio is कविः / कवी / कवयः.

16. (D) कवीन् is the इकारान्त accusative plural ('the poets', object). The nominative plural is कवयः; the genitive plural is कवीनाम्; the instrumental plural is कविभिः. The trap is reading the long ई + -न् as a nominative — but the nominative plural is the -अयः form कवयः.

17. (A) इकारान्त stems merge the ablative and genitive singular into कवेः ('from the poet' and 'of the poet' alike). कवये is the dative singular; कविना the instrumental singular; कवौ the locative singular. This abl.=gen. singular merger is a feature shared by इ- and उ- stems but NOT by अकारान्त (where देवात् ≠ देवस्य).

18. (D) The इकारान्त dative singular is कवये ('to/for the poet'). कवेः is the ablative/genitive singular; कविना is the instrumental singular; कविभ्यः is the dative/ablative plural. Note कवये (sg.) versus the plural कविभ्यः.

19. (D) कविना (-इना) is the इकारान्त instrumental singular: 'by/with the poet'. कविभिः is the instrumental PLURAL ('by the poets'). कवये is the dative singular; कविम् is the accusative singular. The singular instrumental is कविना.

20. (B) The इकारान्त genitive plural is कवीनाम् ('of the poets', with lengthened ई + -नाम्). कवेः is the genitive/ablative singular; कविभ्यः is the dative/ablative plural; कविषु is the locative plural. The genitive plural across stems takes a -नाम् ending (देवानाम्, कवीनाम्, गुरुणाम्).

21. (C) The इकारान्त locative plural is कविषु ('among the poets'). कवौ is the locative singular; कव्योः is the locative/genitive dual; कवीनाम् is the genitive plural. The locative across numbers runs कवौ / कव्योः / कविषु.

22. (D) हरि and मुनि are इकारान्त, so they follow कविः nominative plural हरयः, मुनयः (the -अयः ending seen in कवयः). They do NOT take the अकारान्त -आः (हराः) or the उकारान्त -अवः (हरवः). Stem-ending, not meaning, decides the paradigm.

23. (A) For उकारान्त गुरु the nominative is गुरुः (sg.), गुरु (dual, उ→ऊ), गुरवः (pl., -अवः). गुरुन् is the accusative plural (object); गुरौ is not a valid उ-stem dual (the dual is गुरु); गुरुणाम् is the genitive plural. The nominative trio is गुरुः / गुरु / गुरवः.

24. (A) गुरवे (-अवे) is the उकारान्त dative singular: 'to/for the teacher' (as in गुरवे नमः). गुरवः (-अवः) is the nominative plural: 'the teachers'. They look alike but differ by the final vowel: -ए dative singular versus -अः nominative plural. The instrumental singular is गुरुणा; the genitive singular गुरोः.

25. (B) उकारान्त stems merge the ablative and genitive singular into गुरोः ('from the teacher' and 'of the teacher' alike), parallel to कवेः for इ-stems. गुरवे is the dative singular; गुरुणा the instrumental singular; गुरौ the locative singular. अकारान्त does not show this merger (देवात् ≠ देवस्य).

26. (A) गुरुन् (-ऊन्) is the उकारान्त accusative plural ('the teachers', object). The nominative plural is गुरवः; the ablative singular is गुरोः; the genitive plural is गुरुणाम्. Reading गुरुन् as a nominative is the trap — the nominative plural is गुरवः.

27. (C) The उकारान्त instrumental singular is गुरुणा ('by/with the teacher') — note the retroflex ण after the उ. गुरुभिः is the instrumental plural; गुरवे is the dative singular; the genitive plural is गुरुणाम् (not गुरुणाम्). The singular instrumental is गुरुणा.

28. (A) The उकारान्त genitive plural is गुरुणाम् ('of the teachers', long ऊ + -णाम्). गुरोः is the genitive/ablative singular; गुरुभ्यः is the dative/ablative plural; गुरुणा is the instrumental singular. The genitive plural takes the -णाम् form here (ण after the ऊ).

29. (A) The उकारान्त locative plural is गुरुषु ('among the teachers'). गुरौ is the locative singular; गुरोः is the locative/genitive dual; गुरुणाम् is the genitive plural. The locative across numbers runs गुरौ / गुरोः / गुरुषु.

30. (A) देवात् is the अकारान्त ablative singular ('from the god'); कवेः is the इकारान्त ablative singular ('from the poet') — but in इ-stems that same कवेः ALSO serves as the genitive. So both share the ablative role, with कवेः additionally covering the genitive. They are not the dative (देवाय/कवये) or instrumental (देवेन/कविना).

31. (D) कविना (-इना) is the इकारान्त instrumental singular: 'by/with the poet'. कवीन् (long ई + -न्) is the accusative plural: 'the poets' as object. They differ in both vibhakti (instrumental vs accusative) and vacana (singular vs plural). The dative singular is कवये and the genitive plural कवीनाम्.

32. (D) देवेन, कविना, गुरुणा are all instrumental singular ('by/with the god/poet/teacher'), each with its stem's own ending (-एन, -इना, -उणा). The datives would be देवाय/कवये/गुरवे; the ablatives देवात्/कवेः/गुरोः; the genitives देवस्य/कवेः/गुरोः. Same case-name, same role, different endings.

33. (D) The genitive plurals are देवानाम्, कवीनाम्, गुरुणाम् (all in -आम्/-नाम्/-णाम्, 'of the gods/poets/teachers'). देवेभ्यः/कविभ्यः/गुरुभ्यः are dative/ablative plurals; देवेषु/कविषु/गुरुषु are locative plurals; देवैः/कविभिः/गुरुभिः are instrumental plurals.

34. (C) देवेषु, कविषु, गुरुषु are the locative plurals ('among the gods/poets/teachers'), all ending in -षु. देवानाम्/कवीनाम्/गुरुणाम् are genitive plurals; देवेभ्यः/कविभ्यः/गुरुभ्यः are dative/ablative plurals; देवे/कवौ/गुरौ are the locative SINGULARS.

35. (B) देवेभ्यः, कविभ्यः, गुरुभ्यः are the syncretic dative/ablative plurals ('to/from the gods/poets/teachers'). देवैः/कविभिः/गुरुभिः are instrumental plurals; देवानाम्/कवीनाम्/गुरुणाम् are genitive plurals; देवाय/कवये/गुरवे are the dative SINGULARS.

36. (C) गुरवे (उ-stem) is the dative singular 'to/for the teacher'; कवयः (इ-stem) is the nominative plural 'the poets'. They differ in case (dative vs nominative) and number (singular vs plural). The उ-stem nominative plural would be गुरवः (with -अः), which is NOT the same as the dative गुरवे.

37. (C) The accusative singular adds -म् to the stem: देवम्, कविम्, गुरुम् — so गुरुम् is correct. गुरुन् and देवान् are accusative PLURALS; कवयः is the nominative PLURAL of कवि, not an accusative singular.

38. (B) देवस्य is the genitive singular of देव; the parallel genitive singular of कवि is कवेः. The genitive singular of गुरु is गुरोः (not कवेः); of देव it is देवस्य; and हरि (an इ-stem) makes हरेः, not हरिस्य. So कवेः belongs to कवि.

39. (C) 'Bowing to' takes the dative (चतुर्थी), and the उकारान्त dative singular is गुरवे ('to/for the teacher'). गुरोः is genitive/ablative ('of/from'), गुरुणा instrumental ('by'), गुरौ locative ('in/at'). नम् with a person normally governs the dative, so गुरवे is right.

40. (B) 'From' is the ablative (पञ्चमी), and the इकारान्त ablative singular is कवेः ('from the poet'); it doubles as the genitive but the 'from' sense here is ablative. कवये is dative ('to'), कविना instrumental ('by'), कविम् accusative (object). So कवेः.

41. (C) The particle सह ('with') governs the तृतीया (instrumental), so the उकारान्त instrumental singular गुरुणा ('with the teacher') is right. गुरवे is dative, गुरोः genitive/ablative, गुरौ locative — none fits 'with'.

42. (A) 'Faith IN' takes the locative (सप्तमी), and the अकारान्त locative singular is देवे ('in the god'). देवस्य is genitive ('of'), देवाय dative ('to'), देवेन instrumental ('by'). The locative देवे is correct.

43. (D) 'Two' requires the द्विवचन (dual), and the उकारान्त nominative dual is गुरु ('two teachers'); the dual verb तिष्ठतः confirms it. गुरवः is the plural ('three or more'), गुरुः the singular, and गुरुन् the accusative plural (object). So गुरु.

44. (D) 'Sees the poets' makes the poets the OBJECT (accusative) and 'more than two' makes it plural; the इकारान्त accusative plural is कवीन्. कवयः is the nominative plural (subject); कवी the dual ('two'); कविम् the accusative singular ('one poet'). So कवीन्.

45. (C) 'Bow to' takes the dative, and 'gods' (plural) gives the अकारान्त dative plural देवेभ्यः ('to the gods'). देवान् is accusative plural (object), देवाय the dative SINGULAR, and देवानाम् the genitive plural ('of'). So देवेभ्यः.

46. (C) 'The teacher's pupil' is a possessive, so the genitive (षष्ठी) is needed; the उकारान्त genitive singular is गुरोः. गुरवे is dative ('to'), गुरुणा instrumental ('by'), गुरौ locative ('in'). Note गुरोः covers both genitive and ablative — here the sense is genitive.

47. (D) The agent of a passive ('was composed BY') takes the instrumental (तृतीया); the इकारान्त instrumental singular is कविना ('by the poet'). कवये is dative, कवेः genitive/ablative, कवौ locative — none expresses the agent 'by'. So कविना.

48. (B) तरु declines like गुरु (उकारान्त). 'On the trees' (location, plural) is the locative plural तरुषु, parallel to गुरुषु. तरुणाम् is genitive plural ('of'), तरुभ्यः dative/ablative plural ('to/from'), तरौ the locative SINGULAR ('on one tree'). So तरुषु.

49. (B) The vocative singular differs by stem: अकारान्त merely drops the visarga (देवः → हे देव!); इकारान्त raises इ to ए (कविः → हे कवे!); उकारान्त raises उ to ओ (गुरुः → हे गुरो!). So it is NOT a uniform 'drop -ः', not a uniform -ओ, and not a uniform -ए.

50. (D) The vocative dual mirrors the nominative dual, so for गुरु it is हे गुरु! ('O two teachers!'). हे गुरो! is the vocative SINGULAR; हे गुरवः! is the vocative PLURAL (= nominative plural गुरवः); हे गुरवे! confuses the form with the dative singular गुरवे.

51. (A) The vocative plural matches the nominative plural, so for कवि it is हे कवयः! ('O poets!'). हे कवे! is the vocative singular; हे कवी! is the vocative dual; हे कवीन्! wrongly borrows the accusative plural कवीन्. The vocative plural is हे कवयः!.

52. (B) For उकारान्त nouns the vocative singular is हे गुरो! (the -उः of गुरुः becomes -ओ). Keeping the nominative हे गुरु! is the mistake the student made; हे गुरवे! is the dative and हे गुरुम्! the accusative — neither is a vocative. The rule: उ → ओ in the उकारान्त vocative singular.

53. (B) In all three taught stems the vocative singular changes the nominative: देवः → हे देव! (drops -ः), कविः → हे कवे! (इ→ए), गुरुः → हे गुरो! (उ→ओ). So the claim that the vocative always equals the nominative is false for every stem, not just देव, and the change is in the SINGULAR.

54. (D) हे साधो! shows the उ→ओ shift, which is the उकारान्त vocative singular rule — so साधु declines like गुरु. An अकारान्त vocative merely drops -ः (हे देव!), and an इकारान्त one gives -ए (हे कवे!); neither yields -ओ. साधु is उकारान्त.

55. (C) देवौ is the nominative DUAL ('two gods'); the matching nominative PLURAL ('the gods', many, as subject) is देवाः. देवान् is the accusative plural (object), देवानाम् the genitive plural ('of'), देवेषु the locative plural ('in'). Only देवाः keeps the subject role while shifting dual → plural.

56. (A) Sanskrit's dual marks EXACTLY two, so 'two teachers' must be गुरु, not the plural गुरवः (which means three or more). The child correctly used a dual for the pair of eyes but

then slipped into the plural for the pair of teachers. The dual and plural are NOT interchangeable; गुरुः would mean one teacher.

57. (B) गुरुः is nominative — the giver (subject). शिष्याय (-आय) is the dative — the recipient 'to whom' knowledge is given. ज्ञानम् (-म्) is the accusative — the thing given (object). 'Give' classically takes a dative recipient plus an accusative object, so this reading is right; the others misassign at least one case.

58. (C) देवस्य is the genitive 'of the god / the god's', so 'देवस्य मन्दिरम्' = 'the god's temple' is correct. 'Bow to' needs the dative देवाय; 'come from' needs the ablative देवात्; 'on the god' needs the locative देवे. Each role demands its own case, and only the possessive use fits the genitive देवस्य.

59. (C) गुरोः is the उकारान्त ablative/genitive singular of गुरु; कवेः is the इकारान्त ablative/genitive singular of कवि. They belong to different stems and are not the same form, though both stems do merge ablative and genitive in the singular. They are neither purely genitive nor a dative/instrumental.

60. (A) देवैः (-ऐः) is the instrumental plural; कवीनाम् (-नाम्) the genitive plural; गुरवे (-अवे) the dative singular; देवात् (-आत्) the ablative singular — all four labels match. The other sets misname at least one: e.g. गुरवे is dative singular (not nominative plural गुरुः and not genitive singular गुरोः), and देवात् is ablative (not accusative or genitive).